

Cause and Effect - Workbook 1

Practice direct causes, effects, and mechanisms.

Strategy reminder

Write the relationship as CAUSE -> EFFECT. Then ask whether the passage proves the link or only suggests it. Notice other factors that may also explain the result.

Shaded Bus Stops

Text 1

A city installed fabric shade canopies at six bus stops. Temperature sensors were placed on the benches before and after installation. On sunny afternoons, the shaded benches averaged 6 degrees Celsius cooler than nearby unshaded benches. The canopies did not change the bus schedule or the number of riders.

1. What caused the lower afternoon bench temperatures at the six stops?

- A. The shade canopies reduced direct sunlight
- B. More buses arrived
- C. Fewer riders used the benches
- D. The city changed the schedule

2. Which result is an effect described in the passage?

- A. The city installed canopies
- B. The shaded benches averaged lower temperatures
- C. Sensors were placed before installation
- D. The number of riders was unchanged

Mulch Trial

Text 2

Students planted the same type of bean in two garden beds. One bed received a layer of wood-chip mulch; the other did not. Both beds received the same amount of water. After a hot week, the mulched soil retained more moisture. The students noted that the mulch covered the soil surface and slowed evaporation.

3. Why did the mulched bed retain more moisture, according to the passage?

- A. It received more water
- B. The mulch slowed evaporation
- C. It contained a different type of bean
- D. It was measured on a different day

4. Which factor was kept the same to make the comparison clearer?

- A. Amount of water
- B. Amount of mulch
- C. Soil moisture after the week
- D. Evaporation rate

Late Deliveries

Text 3

A delivery team noticed that packages on Route 4 were arriving late. For one week, the loading crew recorded the order in which vans left the warehouse. The Route 4 van consistently left last because its packages were stored at the back of the loading area. After the storage layout was changed, the van began leaving earlier and late deliveries decreased.

5. What does the passage identify as a cause of Route 4 leaving late?

- A. Customers changed addresses
- B. Route 4 packages were stored at the back of the loading area
- C. The van traveled more slowly after leaving
- D. The team recorded departure times

6. What effect followed the storage-layout change?

- A. Route 4 began leaving earlier and late deliveries decreased
- B. Packages were moved farther back
- C. The team stopped measuring departure times before the change
- D. All routes were eliminated

Review your reasoning

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A - The passage connects the shade to lower temperatures and says the schedule did not change.

Watch for: Do not choose a detail the passage rules out.

2. B - Lower bench temperature is the outcome that followed the shade installation.

Watch for: Do not reverse cause and effect.

3. B - The passage gives a mechanism: mulch covered the surface and slowed evaporation.

Watch for: A causal explanation often includes how the cause produces the result.

4. A - Both beds received the same amount of water, reducing one alternative explanation.

Watch for: A controlled factor is not the cause being tested.

5. B - The location of the packages delayed loading, which delayed departure.

Watch for: Recording a problem is not the same as causing it.

6. A - The passage reports earlier departures and fewer late deliveries after the layout change.

Watch for: Keep the direction of the causal chain clear.